MINUTES OF THE
CITY OF HOLLADAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING

Thursday, May 1, 2025
6:00 p.m.
City Council Chambers
4580 South 2300 East
Holladay, Utah

ATTENDANCE:

Mayor Rob Dahle
Paul Fotheringham
Matt Durham
Ty Brewer
Emily Gray
Drew Quinn- *excused*

City Staff:
Gina Chamness, City Manager
Stephanie Carlson, City Recorder
Todd Godfrey, City Attorney

I. ***Welcome*** – Mayor Dahle.
Mayor Rob Dahle called the City Council Meeting to order at approximately 6:00 p.m.

II. ***Pledge of Allegiance.***
Mayor Dahle led the Pledge of Allegiance.

III. ***Public Comments.***
Before opening the public comment period, Mayor Dahle commented on the Feasibility Study and school district. At the last City Council Meeting, there were several comments made about this matter. Since that time, a meeting was held with eight representatives. Mayor Dahle and several Council Members participated in that discussion. The concerns of the residents were made clear. A lot of the conversation has to do with the Boundary Study and the possibility that some schools will close. Mayor Dahle wants residents to know that there is a willingness to listen to all concerns. Following that discussion, he reached out to the Mayor of South Salt Lake City, who is opposed to a district split at this time. He also spoke to the Mayor of Millcreek City as well as Julie Jackson and Clarke Nelson. There is familiarity with the issue and there will be continued engagement.

Trudy Jorgensen-Price shared updates about the library. She reported that on Mondays, there will be an extra Storytime held. There is still Storytime scheduled to take place on Tuesdays, but on Mondays, it will be in the gazebo. Regular events are still taking place at the library and there will be another RPG for teens and adults on Saturdays starting on May 17, 2025. Ms. Jorgensen-Price reported that on the front lawn on the northwest corner, there is a tree that was granted by NASA. There will be invitations for an event sent out. The tentative date is scheduled for June 5, 2025.

Barbara Faust - 2110 Cresthill Dr and stated that all of her children attended public schools in the area. She expressed support for a Feasibility Study to look into a school district.

Emily Davis - 2007 E Lincoln Cir and previously attended Cottonwood Elementary School, Olympus Junior High School, and Olympus High School. The area that she lives in now was specifically chosen because of the walkability to Crestview Elementary School. It is a thriving center and a vibrant part of the community. She loves that the area is surrounded by children who are learning. Ms. Davis supports the Feasibility Study and pointed out that the Granite School District currently services 60,000 students when the average size is 5,000 students. She believes it is possible to have a smaller school district that is more efficient. It makes sense to look into this kind of study. Ms. Davis stated that many parents she has spoken to do not feel supported by Granite School District.

Emmy Lowe - 4295 Lynne Lane. When these conversations first started, there was a desire to have the City involved in the process. She thanked the City Council for making time so all residents are heard. Ms. Lowe shared a comment from someone she knows who stated that the City Council Meetings happen at a busy time of the evening. This makes it difficult for some parents to attend and share comments in person. There are many more who would like to attend. Ms. Lowe informed the Council that residents are interested in a Feasibility Study to see what makes sense. She pointed out that school district conversations have been happening for a long time. However, it is now clear that some sort of action needs to be taken. She feels it should be addressed at this time.

Betsy VanDenBerghe - 4206 Cumberland Rd. Her priority is on small school districts, which is the reason the Small Districts Coalition was formed in the past. She supports small districts because smaller districts create smaller schools, smaller class sizes, and higher academic achievement. It is a better arrangement for the students. After there are 10,000 to 20,000 students, the economies of scale disappear and it becomes more of a bloated bureaucracy. Cities are afraid of losing special programs, but that is something the Feasibility Study could look into. She noted that smaller districts are able to use their funding in a way that is better for the school and the students. It was pointed out that larger districts tend to close schools more often than smaller districts. She feels it is important for the community to consider what makes the most sense for the area moving forward.

Lisa Bagley lives on Honeycut Road in Millcreek. She is an empty nester and three of her four daughters graduated from Olympus High School. In 2016, two-thirds of Millcreek City residents voted to become a City, because there was a feeling that they were not being listened to by Salt Lake County. Residents wanted local control, autonomy, and representation. There is a desire now to have a Feasibility Study conducted so cities like Holladay, Millcreek, and South Salt Lake can have that same kind of local control, autonomy, and representation. She expressed support for the study.

Taylor Davis - 2490 E Lambourne Ave in Millcreek. Two years ago, he attended a meeting about the school closures, and a slide was shared to explain who decides what schools close. There were 20 boxes shown on the slide, but only one of those was community engagement. There are some questions about what will happen in the future with some of the different schools. It is important to have community representatives for each of the schools. He believes the Feasibility Study makes sense and stressed the importance of appropriate representation. There will continue to be discussions about this. He hopes the City Council will support the proposed study.

Jed VanDenBerghe - 4206 Cumberland Road. He grew up in South Salt Lake and the schools he attended do not exist anymore. When certain schools have closed over the years, it has changed the community. Mr. VanDenBerghe noted that Murray has its own district, which includes a high school, two junior high schools, and several elementary schools. Those schools are thriving and people love the school district. He believes having local control has been beneficial for Holladay as a City and he believes it would also be good for schools.

Marissa Skinner - 1800 North Woodside Dr. Her family has been in Millcreek and Holladay for over 120 years. Something she loves about the area is the entrepreneurial spirit that exists in the community. Business owners often look at what is working and what is not. When it comes to the school district, it makes sense to look at what is and is not working at this time. That is essentially what the Feasibility Study will do. It will provide information and data so a decision can be made.

Katie Knudson lives in Millcreek but has children who attend local schools. This highlights how integrated the community is. She expressed support for a Feasibility Study and exploring the possibility of a new school district. Her interest in this started two years ago when Millcreek Elementary School was closed. Based on those meetings, it was clear that there was not a strong local voice. That process made her want to have more of a say about what is happening in the schools. Ms. Knudson has children in elementary school, junior high school, and high school. As a parent, she would love to have more of a say in the decisions made. She stressed the importance of local representation. There is an opportunity to pursue a Feasibility Study to determine what makes sense.

Ryan Reynolds - 5230 S Wander Ln. His family has lived in Holladay for generations and he currently has a daughter at Cottonwood Elementary School. Mr. Reynolds expressed his support for the Feasibility Study. He coaches football at Olympus High School. There have been instances when new equipment was needed, but that purchase is not possible, because it might be considered unfair to other schools. With a smaller school district, it would make the allocation of funds more effective. It makes sense to consolidate and establish something smaller.

Tracey Walker - 2341 Edgemoor Dr. She attended the recent meeting with Mayor Dahle and thanked him for the opportunity to share different perspectives. Ms. Walker is in support of the Feasibility Study. She has been in this district for 17 years and has six children. Parents have worked hard to improve the schools, but there are still outstanding issues. She discussed some of the limitations associated with the Granite School District. The schools are full, but it is not because of the Granite School District. It is because of the culture, community, and efforts made by others. Ms. Walker believes that the Granite School District is too large and feels there could be a better way of running things. There is a lot of community support for the proposed Feasibility Study.

Ed Bagley - 3387 Honeycut Rd, Millcreek. When his family moved to Cincinnati for four years, there was a different situation with the school districts. There were high schools that had specialties. For example, a school that was more focused on arts and a school that was more focused on athletics. That impacted the neighborhoods and there was a lot of vibrancy. There was

a collaboration between the school districts for certain economies of scale. After coming back from Cincinnati, there were discussions about closing Wasatch Junior High School. Mr. Bagley explained that he had mentioned this as a way to express support for the Feasibility Study process.

Mindy Lofgren read a quote from a Board Member of the Jordan School District. When the Jordan School District was looking to split, the Board Member was in opposition. That Board Member has shared more recent comments and stated that he would vote differently now regarding the division of the Jordan School District. The Canyons School District has thrived and the Jordan School District has continued to flourish. Both districts have the ability to focus on more localized needs in ways that a larger organization cannot. Ms. Lofgren feels that the quote is applicable to the current situation.

Claudia Borden - 2096 E Country Pine Cove. She has lived in Holladay for almost 20 years and has eight children. All of her children have been students in the Granite School District. She loves the opportunities that are in Holladay and discussed the importance of smaller class sizes. Ms. Borden voiced her support for the Feasibility Study, as it is an opportunity for Holladay to make a meaningful difference in the lives and education of future students.

Lindsey Skinner - 3956 S 2000 E and explained that what she likes about the area is the small community feel. She expressed support for the Feasibility Study that has been proposed.

Mary Barnson - 5114 Loredell Dr. She explained that people like the small community feel in the area. It seems like common sense to pursue a Feasibility Study to find out whether a district split makes sense or not. She has experience with both private schools and public schools. There are benefits to both. Ms. Barnson reiterated her desire to see the study happen.

Ruth Tenney - 2134 E Sahara Dr and expressed support for the Feasibility Study. She has a daughter and is passionate about her education. A smaller district with more attention focused on each school would be beneficial. She is supportive of making improvements to the system.

Ashley Mcintosh - 1895 E Eldorado Dr. She has four children enrolled and has had positive experiences with many of the teachers. She is very passionate about education for her children and for others in the community. The current class sizes are large. It was clear early on that the second-grade class would be difficult, as the teacher did not have the support needed. Ms. Mcintosh had a meeting with the principal and the teacher and offered support. Several parents now take turns to assist the teacher. She loves the community, school, and teachers, but feels more is needed. Ms. Mcintosh asked that the Council consider the public comments. She feels the Feasibility Study makes sense and will ensure that teachers and students have the best outcome.

John and Abbie McBride - 4215 S Cumberland Rd and they are in favor of exploring this option. If the district split does not make sense based on the Feasibility Study, then that is good to know. However, the size of the current school district is concerning, as there are 60,000 students. Mr. McBride stated that they have six children in the school system. The study is a small cost and can let residents know more about the impacts. He feels it makes sense to support the proposed study.

Lauren Reynolds - 5230 S Wander Lane and stated that she is in support of the Feasibility Study. She feels the study should be a priority for the community, as it impacts many residents. Having more neighborhood schools is likely to bring more families into the area.

Karen Brantzeg - 3036 E Casto Lane. Her family moved to Holladay a few years back, but she has lived in Dallas and Seattle. She is familiar with larger school districts and the impacts of school closures. Ms. Brantzeg is in favor of the Feasibility Study and would like to see it move ahead.

Mayor Dahle thanked everyone for sharing comments and for their civility during this process. He noted that other residents interested in sharing comments can reach out via email or phone. There is a willingness to meet with members of the community at a time that is more convenient to them.

IV. *Presentations:*

a) Utah Recycling Alliance.

Mayor Dahle reported that there will be a presentation from the Utah Recycling Alliance ("URA"). Robi Overson introduced himself and discussed the Collection of Hard to Recycle Materials ("CHaRM") event that was held on March 29, 2025. He thanked the City of Holladay for allowing the event to take place. It was a success, as the materials collected are not readily accepted through curbside collection in the City. Mr. Overson shared images from the event and explained that URA is partnering with cities and communities in this effort. There is a lot of material that is recyclable but is more difficult to recycle when it is not included in the curbside program. Holding events once or twice a year in a community can address some of the existing needs.

163 vehicles participated in the recent CHaRM event and 53% of those were from Holladay. Mr. Overson reported that there has been a lot of support for the event. There were 7,683 pounds of materials collected in three hours, which included 3,600 pounds of electronic waste. There were also 600 pounds of scrap metal, 800 pounds of tires, and 1,200 pounds of mattresses collected.

Mayor Dahle noted that from what he heard, the event was successful and there was a positive response. He likes the idea of bringing this service to residents and he feels it makes sense from a budget standpoint. Council Member Paul Fotheringham agrees that this makes sense in terms of the budget. He made note of the impact of this event. It was well received and there were a lot of participants. This could be something of a tradition where residents are able to count on scheduled CHaRM events. Public education and a reliable schedule could increase the level of participation over time. Mr. Overson noted that URA is constantly looking into other materials that can be added to the recycling list.

Council Member Ty Brewer asked about past CHaRM events that URA has handled. Mr. Overson reported that URA has been around for several years and the CHaRM event has been around for approximately four years. In 2024, there were between 75 and 100 vehicles per event and there were five events held. There have been five events in 2025 already and the average is between 125 and 150 vehicles. Statistically, the number of events and the number of vehicles has increased. The 163 vehicles at the latest event is the highest number so far.

Discussions were had about funding. Mr. Overson believes that with increases in volume, there will eventually be increased costs. At that time, there will need to be efforts made to subsidize the needs through donations and sponsors. He reiterated that educating members of the public is important. Council Members expressed support for the CHaRM event and thanked URA for the presentation.

b) Central Wasatch Commission – Lindsey Nielsen, Executive Director.

Mayor Dahle reported that there will be a presentation from the Central Wasatch Commission ("CWC"). Executive Director, Lindsey Nielsen, introduced herself to the City Council. She explained that the CWC has invited Holladay to become a member of the CWC. There are eight other jurisdictions currently participating in the organization. The intention of the CWC is to collectively address the issues facing the Central Wasatch mountains. Ms. Nielsen has been with the CWC for seven years.

The CWC was created in 2017 by an Interlocal Agreement. It is an Interlocal Governmental Entity, which means it is composed of other governments. The CWC came out of the Mountain Accord process, which was a collaborative response to the fact that decisions impacting specific systems in the mountains were happening in a piecemeal manner. Decisions happening in one system were having impacts on all of the other systems. The four systems that the CWC uses as a guidepost are: the economy system (the Cottonwood Canyons ski resorts and small businesses), transportation system (how people get to the mountains and how people travel around the mountains), recreation system (the recreational opportunities in the mountains), and the environment system (the land, water, and wildlife). The goal of the Mountain Accord was to work collaboratively with representatives from each of the four systems to sustain the mountains for years to come. The Mountain Accord process lasted for approximately three years and it resulted in a charter that was signed by over 100 stakeholders. The charter called for many things, including the creation of a government entity to carry out the plans that were devised by the experts during the Mountain Accord process. That entity is the CWC.

The CWC involves locally elected officials operating by consensus. The intention is to work together in pursuit of one unified goal, which is the stewardship of the four systems in the Central Wasatch. The organization facilitates conflict resolution, convenes, and considers ideas about what to do in the mountains. Ms. Nielsen review who is involved in the CWC. She reiterated that the CWC is a consensus-driven organization. Land and watershed protection decision-making is approached through consensus. Ms. Nielsen explained that all CWC Board Members have equal footing and an equal voice. She next reviewed some of the projects the CWC has been involved with over the years, including the Short-Term Projects Grant Program, Central Wasatch Symposium, and Central Wasatch Dashboard. There is also stakeholder and youth involvement in the organization through the Stakeholders Council and the CWC Youth Council.

Each of the member jurisdictions, including the Ex-Officio Members, contribute to the CWC. The organization is member jurisdiction funded. There are also yearly appropriations from the State of Utah. The member fees have been broken down into three tiers: Tier 1, Tier 2, and Tier 3. The larger tier is Tier 3, the medium tier is Tier 2, and the smaller tier is Tier 1. What determines the tier level is population size, tax revenue, and geographic location. Ms. Nielsen offered to answer questions.

Council Member Brewer believes the CWC provides a platform where cities can convene and coordinate. Ms. Nielsen explained that the CWC is not a legislative body. The goal of the CWC is to convene and collectively tackle issues. It is a recommending body rather than a legislative body. Council Member Gray thanked Ms. Nielsen for presenting the information and for meeting with her previously. She believes the work of the CWC is needed to protect the Central Wasatch. She feels collaborative efforts can help solve problems and referenced the Ski Bus Priority Access Program. Mayor Dahle pointed out that Council Member Gray is passionate about the work of the organization, as her district abuts Big Cottonwood Canyon. He asked what the initial fee would be for Holladay to participate. Ms. Nielsen reported that $25,000 has been discussed for Holladay. That would be between Tier 1 and Tier 2. The reason that Holladay has been invited to participate is due to the location of the City and the impacts on the community.

If there is support from the City Council for Holladay to participate in the CWC, then Council Member Gray would be added as a formal CWC Board Member during the June 23, 2025, CWC Board Meeting. The organization runs on a fiscal year, so the member invoice would be sent in July. City Manager, Gina Chamness, wanted to know whether Holladay would need to be a party to the Interlocal Agreement, which was confirmed. Ms. Nielsen reported that there would need to be an amendment to the Interlocal Agreement to add the City of Holladay. Each of the member jurisdictions would have to approve the newly amended Interlocal Agreement with that addition. Discussions were had about the current members. Mayor Dahle thanked Ms. Nielsen for presenting to the Council.

V. *Public Hearing on Title 2 Code Update.*

Mayor Dahle opened the public hearing. There were no comments. The public hearing was closed.

VI. *Consideration of Ordinance 2025-06 - Restricting the Use of Personal Fireworks.*

Council Member Fotheringham noted that this will replicate what happened last year, but he does not believe this ordinance deserves a unanimous vote. He is voting against the ordinance so there will be future consideration of this matter. There is not a severe drought situation, but there is still a longer-term drought cycle. He reiterated that he does not believe this ordinance should receive a unanimous vote.

Council Member Durham moved to APPROVE Ordinance 2025-06 – Restricting the Use of Personal Fireworks. Council Member Gray seconded the motion. Vote on Motion: Council Member Brewer-Aye; Council Member Durham-Aye; Council Member Fotheringham-Nay; Council Member Gray-Aye; Mayor Dahle-Aye. The motion passed with a vote of 4-to-1.

VII. *Presentation of the 2025-2026 Tentative Budgets – Gina Chamness.*

Ms. Chamness reported that during the first regularly scheduled meeting in May, the City Council must be presented with and approve a Tentative Budget. Over the past several years, a plan has been implemented for financial sustainability and infrastructure improvements in the City. The bond that was issued three years ago allowed the City to make significant improvements to neighborhood streets and stormwater infrastructure. Throughout the summer, many of those stormwater infrastructure projects will be completed

Ms. Chamness noted that the budget was done with the priorities of the Council in mind and also prioritizes employees. There is a cost of living adjustment ("COLA") for Staff as well as some targeted market increases to make sure that Holladay attracts and retains high-quality Staff to best serve residents and meet the outlined goals. Ms. Chamness reported that sales tax is approximately a third of the overall General Fund revenue. Sales tax has stagnated, so there is a flat sales tax projected in the budget. The budget does not propose a property tax increase. The City Council's decision last year to implement an inflationary property tax increase was referenced. Since there is not anticipated to be much in the way of sales tax growth, the Tentative Budget does not include new positions or significant new programming. However, it does analyze the cost of the two part-time positions that were approved in a budget amendment approximately one month ago.

The component of growth in this budget reflects inflationary increases among some programming and partner agencies. Ms. Chamness reported that the largest is from the Unified Police Department ("UPD"). There will be an opportunity to further review those changes over the next several weeks. She looks forward to having continued conversations with the City Council prior to Final Budget adoption. There is a schedule that breaks up the budget discussions by department. Next week, the Council will discuss the following: Capital Projects, Parks, Public Services, and the Stormwater Fund.

Mayor Dahle encouraged Council Members to review the Tentative Budget, make notes, and schedule time with Staff to answer some of the smaller questions. There will be a City Council discussion at the City Council Meetings scheduled on May 8, 15, and June 5, 2025.

VIII. ***Consideration of Resolution 2025-09 - Acknowledging Receipt of and Adopting the Tentative 2025-2026 Fiscal Year Budgets and Setting a Public Hearing for June 4, 2025.***

Council Member Fotheringham moved to APPROVE Resolution 2025-09 – Acknowledging Receipt of and Adopting the Tentative 2025-2026 Fiscal Year Budgets and Setting a Public Hearing for June 4, 2025. Council Member Brewer seconded the motion. Vote on Motion: Council Member Brewer-Aye; Council Member Durham-Aye; Council Member Fotheringham-Aye; Council Member Gray-Aye; Mayor Dahle-Aye. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

IX. ***City Manager Report – Gina Chamness.***

Ms. Chamness had nothing to report to the City Council.

X. ***Council Reports and District Issues.***

Council Member Brewer reported that May is Preservation Month in Holladay. There are historical signs throughout the City with QR codes. Those signs are in front of some historic homes and buildings so residents can learn more about the history of certain sites. Additionally, he noted that Martha Bradley-Evans will be speaking on May 12, 2025, at 7:00 p.m. Council Member Brewer shared a comment about fireworks. He appreciates what was said by Council Member Fotheringham during that agenda item. He hopes that there will be a culture of respect developed for the boundaries that have been set. It is important to encourage residents to adhere to the regulations.

Council Member Matt Durham reported that there was a successful Arbor Day event at Cottonwood Elementary School last Friday. The Tree Committee was there and Council Member Fotheringham also attended. Three trees were planted and those trees were named. Some poetry was read by students and it was a wonderful event overall. The arborists who attended were good about engaging with the students and answering questions. The Tree Committee worked hard on organizing that event. Council Member Durham reminded those present that the Tree Giveaway will take place on May 17, 2025. It will take place from 9:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m. on Holladay Boulevard behind City Hall. There are still 30 medium trees available, so anyone interested in one of those can register.

Council Member Fotheringham reported that the Arts Council is hosting another art show next week. It is a nature-based art event and the artwork will be hung starting on May 5, 2025. The show will run from Tuesday through Saturday. The Blue Moon Festival will undergo some changes this year and will run on September 13, 2025. There will be a slightly different format than there has been in the past. The Arts Council is currently working out some of those details. He will share more information when it is available. Council Member Fotheringham stated that the Unified Fire Authority ("UFA") has their annual banquet scheduled for this weekend and he will report back on that.

Council Member Gray reported that the principal at Cottonwood High School is moving into the administration at Granite School District, so there will be a new principal. She has not met the new principal yet but has heard a lot of positive things. As for Wasatch Front Waste and Recycling, the Board voted this week to move to monthly billing starting in February 2026. Concurrent with this, there will be a push to encourage customers to sign up for e-billing rather than paper billing. Pam Roberts, the General Manager of Wasatch Front Waste and Recycling, has announced her intention to retire. Council Member Gray noted that she has been a wonderful leader for the organization. The Board will soon start the process and look for someone who is able to take over that position.

Mayor Dahle reminded those present that Public Safety Appreciation Week starts on May 5, 2025. There will be thank you banners placed in front of the Fire Station and Precinct. Additionally, there will be some banners advertising the Pancake Breakfast in front of City Hall and in the plaza. Mayor Dahle reported that the Pancake Breakfast will take place on May 10, 2025. There will also be small tokens of appreciation given out to make it clear that first responders are appreciated in the community. Mayor Dahle referenced the Feasibility Study and pointed out that residents care a lot about Holladay.

XI. ***Adjourn.***

Council Member Fotheringham moved to ADJOURN. Council Member Gray seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

The City Council Meeting adjourned at approximately 8:03 p.m.

I hereby certify that the foregoing represents a true, accurate, and complete record of the Holladay City Council Meeting held Thursday, May 1, 2025.

Stephanie N. Carlson, MMC Holladay City Recorder	Robert Dahle, Mayor

Minutes approved: **June 5, 2025**